

MAINTENANCE REQUIRED

written by

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Logline: A man furious at everyone slowing him down through the
nightlife chaos will do anything to catch the last train out of
London.

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FADE IN:

1 **I/E - TAXI - MODERN ROAD - NIGHT**

1

A man sits in the backseat of a TAXI, stressed. He checks his phone. 0:50 AM. He focuses to the driver.

 MAN
Feeling tired?

 TAXI DRIVER
No...
 (he glances to the man, do
 I look tired?)

 MAN
Then what are you doing? Go.
 (beat)
I mean Jesus man! There's barely
any cars and you're still driving
like my goddamn grandma.

The Taxi driver gives a look, then accelerates...

 MAN (CONT'D)
Where was this speed twenty minutes
ago? Two minutes.

He turns back to his phone, starts a 10 minute clock.

2 **I/E - TAXI - BUSY ROAD - NIGHT**

2

The taxi rounds the corner into a BUSY STRIP. NEON LIGHTS
FLICKER. Drunk crowds spilling onto the road.

The driver slows down at the sight of this.

 MAN
God, couldn't you have taken
another route?

 TAXI DRIVER
No, no. Map say this way.

A group of drunk pedestrians step off the curb without
looking. The taxi BRAKES sharply.

 MAN
Jesus-

A drunk guy TAPS the hood like it's a party.

DRUNK GUY
Yo! Where you headed?

MAN
(to himself)
Oh my God...

He looks at the phone.

The clock is RUNNING. 00:53.

MAN (CONT'D)
(under his breath)
Dear Lord, just get me there...

The taxi INCHES FORWARD again, weaving through people who don't care the car is there.

MAN (CONT'D)
Are you serious?

TAXI DRIVER
London night. Always like this.

MAN
Yeah, well I'm dying in it.

3 **EXT. - CROSSWALK - NIGHT**

3

A group of ladies stagger onto the street, then freeze. The driver motions. Ladies un-reactive.

The man ROLLS down his WINDOW, sticks his head out-

MAN
(to the ladies)
It's a green light ladies! Get out the road!

He signals them to get off the road. The ladies mistake this for an invitation to get in. They approach the taxi.

4 **I/E - TAXI - BUSY ROAD - NIGHT**

4

MAN
Jesus christ. No no, Wrong message.

One of the women TRIES the DOOR HANDLE.

CLICK. Locked. They bang on the backseat window:

LADY
You free?

MAN
Not now lady.
(to driver)
Drive.

But the taxi driver is too focused on the hot ladies.

MAN (CONT'D)
Eyes on the road.

The driver blinks.

DRIVER
...I check- traffic.

MAN
There is no traffic dude. Just
road. And your job.

A beat.

The driver nods slowly....then immediately sneaks another
look in the mirror.

5 **EXT. BUSY ROAD EXIT**

5

WHROOM. They make it out alive, shortly ROLL into a lonely
train station.

6 **EXT. TRAIN STATION - NIGHT**

6

He gets out the car, tips the driver.

MAN
Don't go back there and spend it
all in one night, alright?

The driver nods, drives off.

He skips every second step into the train station.

MAN (CONT'D)
Shit. Here we go...

He leaves us in the cold, entering the--

7 **INT. TRAIN STATION CONCOURSE**

7

Security guards the ticket barriers. His eyes focus on the departure board. One last train tonight. Five minutes.

He turns to the only open ticket kiosk. Unfortunately even in the deadest of nights, he still can't keep away from London queues.

MAN
Fucking horse shit.

All hope is **lost**, but then shortly regained when---

A maintenance man places a toolbox beside his feet.

Fortunately for him, the toolbox is stuffed with a hi-vis. He's got an idea.

8 **SOON LATER**

8

Now with hi-vis, he approaches the officer, who is inside a reinforced glass booth.

MAN
(putting on an accent)
Hey, 'cuse me.

The ticket barrier officer appears to be sleeping.

The train pulls into the platform. The man, now becoming more frustrated, knocks on the glass. On the third knock, she awakes.

MAN (CONT'D)
Mind letting me through?

TICKET OFFICER
(disorientated)
Uhh..What department?

MAN
Maintenance.

She confirms with a clipboard.

TICKET OFFICER
At 1AM?

MAN
Yes at 1 AM.

TICKET OFFICER
No "maintenance man" on my list.
(beat)
What are you fixing?

MAN
Those light bulbs.
(he points to flickering
lights)
If I were you, I would open these
gates quickly. You see, they are
about to blow the fuse. Whole
station goes dark.
(beat)
Speak with the Mark if you'd like.

He checks his phone — 00:58.

She sighs. A subsequent BUZZ springs — the ticket barriers
jitter open.

9

EXT. PLATFORM - NIGHT

9

He turns the corner, then removes the hi-vis.

The train stands still. He made it. He actually did it.

FADE TO BLACK.